

Zhuofei Lu

Postdoctoral Researcher in Sociology, University of Oxford

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Academic Employment & Affiliation

- 03.2024 – Present** Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford
‘GenTime’ project
- 07.2024 – Present** Course Convenor, School of Global and Area Studies / Department of Sociology, University of Oxford
- 01.2025 – 01.2027** College Advisor, St Antony’s College, University of Oxford

Education

- 09.2021 – 06.2024** Ph.D. in Social Statistics and Sociology (joint), University of Manchester
Supervisors: Prof. Wendy Olsen (socio-economics) & Prof. Yaojun Li (sociology)
- 09.2023 – 11.2023** Visiting Ph.D. Researcher, Sciences Po, Paris
Collaborator: Prof. Laurent Lesnard
- 09.2020 – 09.2021** M.Sc. in Social Statistics (Distinction), University of Manchester
Supervisor: Prof. Tarani Chandola
- 09.2019 – 09.2020** M.A. in Communication (Merit), Hong Kong Baptist University
- 09.2015 – 09.2019** B.A. in Marketing Management, Hong Kong Baptist University

Teaching

- 07.2024 – Present** Course Convenor, School of Global and Area Studies / Department of Sociology, University of Oxford
– Quantitative Research Methods (MPhil level)
– Statistics Methods (MSc in Sociology)
- 07.2024 – Present** Master’s Supervisor / Examiner, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford
- 01.2025 – 06.2025** College Tutor, Hertford College, University of Oxford
Demographic research (BA in Human Sciences)
- 07.2024 – Present** Sequence Analysis in R (annual workshop), Centre for Time Use Research, UCL
- 01.2022 – 01.2024** Course Instructor, Department of Social Statistics, University of Manchester
– Introduction to Statistical Models
– The Survey Method in Social Research
– Statistical Models for Social Networks
– Structural Equations Modelling

Research Interests

Sociology of work · well-being · time use · social stratification · machine learning · GenAI literacy

Editorial & Academic Service

- Editorial Board Member, *Work, Employment & Society* (ABS4), 02.2026 – 02.2030
- Editorial Board Member, *Social Science Research* (ABS3), 01.2025 – 01.2027
- Associate Editor, *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, 04.2024 – 04.2027
- Researcher Representative, Department of Sociology Research Committee, University of Oxford, 10.2025 – 01.2027
- PhD Student Representative, University of Manchester, 12.2022 – 12.2023

Peer reviewer for: Social Science & Medicine; Work, Employment & Society; Journal of Marriage and Family; Nature Cities; Demographic Research; Social Science Research; Research in Social Stratification and Mobility; Social Problems; Journal of Social Computing; Journal of Happiness Studies; Sociological Quarterly; Socius; European Psychiatry; Scientific Reports; BMC Geriatrics; BMC Systematic Reviews; Journal of Time Use Research; Global Health Action; International Journal of Women's Health; Current Psychology.

Publications

Lu, Z. indicates the author; * indicates corresponding author.

- [1] Lyv, W. & **Lu, Z.*** (co-first authors), Wang, S. & Kan, M.-Y. (2026). Vertical Education-Occupation Mismatch and Gender Division of Labour: A Longitudinal Dyadic Analysis in the UK during 2002–2023. *Work, Employment & Society*.
- [2] Cui, S., **Lu, Z.*** & Wang, S. (2025). Gender and Parenthood Disparities in Work Time Fragmentation in the United States. *Social Indicators Research*.
- [3] Guo, Y., Cui, S., **Lu, Z.** & Wang, S. (2025). Dependence and Precarity in the Gig Economy: A Longitudinal Analysis of Platform Work and Mental Distress. *British Journal of Sociology*.
- [4] **Lu, Z.**, He, Y., Shi, X., Xiao, S., Wang, Z. & Wen, Y. (2025). The Gendered Inequalities in the Mental Consequences of Work Time Fragmentation: Latest Time Use Evidence in the UK. *Social Indicators Research*.
- [5] Lei, C. & **Lu, Z.*** (2025). The association between financial strain and mental health: The mediating and moderating roles of sleep problems in the UK household longitudinal study (UKHLS). *Journal of Affective Disorders*.
- [6] Lei, C., Wang, S. & **Lu, Z.*** (2025). The role of loneliness in mediating the relationship between financial strain and mental health: Exploring gender differences in a UK longitudinal study. *Public Health*, 242, 299–303.
- [7] Lei, C. & **Lu, Z.*** (2024). Loneliness as a Mediator in the Association Between Food Insecurity and Multiple Sleep Problems: Evidence From the 2021/22 UK Household Longitudinal Study. *American Journal of Health Promotion*.
- [8] Ling, W., Wang, S. & **Lu, Z.*** (2024). Working Time Mismatch and Employee Subjective Well-being Across Institutional Contexts: A Job Quality Perspective. *Work, Employment & Society*.
- [9] **Lu, Z.*** (2024). Can work time fragmentation influence workers' subjective time pressure? The roles of gender and parenthood. *Sociology* (BSA).
- [10] **Lu, Z.**, Wang, S.*, Ling, W. & Guo, Y. (2023). Gig Work and Mental Health during the Covid-19 Pandemic: A Gendered Examination of Comparisons with Regular Employment and Unemployment. *Social Science & Medicine*.
- [11] **Lu, Z.**, Wang, S.* & Olsen, W. (2023). Revisiting the 'flexibility paradox': degree of work schedule flexibility and time use patterns across gender and occupational groups. *Humanities*

and *Social Sciences Communications*.

- [12] **Lu, Z.** & Zhuang, W.* (2023). Can Teleworking Improve Workers' Job Satisfaction? Exploring the Roles of Gender and Emotional Well-Being. *Applied Research in Quality of Life*.
- [13] **Lu, Z.***, Wang, S., Li, Y., Liu, X. & Olsen, W. (2023). Who gains mental health benefits from work autonomy? The roles of gender and occupational class. *Applied Research in Quality of Life*.
- [14] Wang, S. & **Lu, Z.*** (equal authorship, 2022). Is Paid Inflexible Work Better than Unpaid Housework for Women's Mental Health? The Moderating Role of Parenthood. *Applied Research in Quality of Life*.
- [15] Wang, S., Li, L.Z., **Lu, Z.**, Li, S. & Rehkopf, D. (equal authorship, 2022). Work schedule control and allostatic load biomarkers: Disparities between and within gender. *Social Indicators Research*.

Under Review & Working Papers

- Double Disadvantages? A Longitudinal Study Exploring Intersectional Disparities in Life Satisfaction Among Gig Workers by Gender and Ethnicity. *Major revision in an ABS4 journal*.

Conference Presentations

- International Conference on Social Computing 2026: *National Media and Scholarly Contexts of Social Stratification in AI Literacy and Acceptance Across Europe*.
- International Conference on Social Computing 2026: *The Gendered Linguistic Geometry of Everyday Spaces in American English Discourse, 1900–2009: Domain-Conditional Feminization and the Asymmetric Emergence of Private Vocabulary*.
- ASA 120th Annual Meeting — Demography and the Future of Work (paper session): *Gender and Parenthood Disparities in Work Time Fragmentation in the United States*.
- ASA 120th Annual Meeting — Gender and Work (round table): *Vertical Education-Occupation Mismatch and Gender Division of Labour: A Longitudinal Dyadic Analysis in the UK*.
- 46th International Association for Time Use Research Conference (session chair & oral): *Impact of Work-Family Role Switching on Daily and Instantaneous Enjoyment: A Gendered Time-Use Analysis in the UK*.
- BSA Annual Conference 2023 — Sociological Voices in Public Discourse (oral): *Work time fragmentation and subjective time pressure: evidence from the latest UK time use survey*.
- BSA Work, Employment & Society Conference 2023 (oral): *Can homeworkers have more stable work schedules? A time-use approach to measure work schedule instability*.
- 82nd Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management (paper session): *Work Time Control and Allostatic Load Biomarkers: Differences Between and Within Genders*.

Invited Lectures, Speeches & Interviews

- Expert interview, BBC News Brasil, 8 June 2026: on proposals to reduce Brazil's standard working week and the implications of flexible working for workers' well-being and gender inequality. "*Fim da escala 6x1: por que jornada flexível pode aumentar exploração do trabalhador, segundo pesquisador de Oxford*."
- Seminar, Business School, University of East Anglia, 26 May 2026: "AI literacy and acceptance in 11 European countries."
- Seminar, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford, 27 April 2026: "The National Context of Social Stratification of AI Literacy and Acceptance in Europe."
- Government of Alberta's Public Safety and Emergency Services Meeting, 2 September 2025: "How quantitative social research can support evidence-based practice and policy evaluation."
- Roundtable presentation: *Women and health: building healthier working lives*. Understanding Society & King's Global Institute for Women's Leadership, 16 July 2024.

Grants & Awards

- John Fell Fund (OUP Research Fund), University of Oxford (2026), £10,000, PI: “The National-Level Media and Scholarly Contexts of Social Stratification in Artificial Intelligence Literacy and Acceptance in Europe” (07.2026 – 01.2027).
- Reward & Recognition Award, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford (2026), £400, for outstanding contributions across research, teaching, supervision, public engagement, and departmental service.
- ESRC Impact Acceleration Account (IAA) Award for Public Engagement (2025), £1,000.
- Chinese Government Award for Outstanding PhD Students Abroad (2024), \$6,000.

Technical Skills

Software: R, Python, Stata, High-Performance Computing, SQL, L^AT_EX, GitHub, SPSS, UCINET.

Statistical methods: NLP, machine learning, sequence analysis, survival analysis, causal inference, multilevel modelling, longitudinal SEM, social network analysis, complex survey design.

Datasets: Corpus data (e.g. Google Ngram), news outlets (e.g. GDELT), multinational household panels (e.g. UKHLS), time diaries (e.g. MTUS, UKTUS, ATUS), biomarker data (e.g. ELSA).

Professional Memberships

Sequence Analysis Association · British Sociological Association · British Population Association · Work and Family Researchers Network

Languages

English (fluent) · Mandarin (native) · Cantonese (fluent) · Hokkien (fluent)

Last updated: July 2026.